

Teacher card

Hanukkah and the theme of light / GROW_RE_A1_W04

Outcome: Describe how light is used at Hanukkah and explain one meaning it can represent.

Evidence to retain: F: “What happens? What does it mean?” response.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Model pronunciation without overloading; focus on meaning rather than trivia; avoid presenting one family practice as universal.

Access and regulation

Chunked story; numbered sequencing; symbol prompts; reduced writing; verbal/scribed option; key words pre- taught.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

This is learning about religion and worldviews, not worship. Nobody is asked to share a personal belief, family detail or loss.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner’s individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner’s evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: Give one meaning of light at Hanukkah.

Evidence: C The oil: They rededicated the Temple and lit its lamp. Tradition says there was only enough pure oil for one day, but it lasted eight. D Hanukkah today: Jewish families light one more light each night for eight nights. The lights recall the rededication and stand for faith and hope.

Think aloud: Remembering the rededication of the Temple, faith or hope.

Check: How many nights does Hanukkah last? Eight nights.

Arrival answers

1. Good overcoming evil, hope or welcome.
2. A Jewish festival of lights that lasts eight nights
3. Remembering the rededication of the Temple, faith or hope.
4. Eight nights.

Shared activity reasoning

1. The Temple is taken over and misused — 1. The story starts with the loss of the Temple.
2. The Maccabees win the Temple back — 2. The victory comes next.
3. The lamp is lit and the oil lasts eight days — 3. The rededication follows the victory.
4. Families light the menorah for eight nights — 4. This is how the story is remembered today.

Exit responses

Give one meaning of light at Hanukkah. Remembering the rededication of the Temple, faith or hope.

How many nights does Hanukkah last? Eight nights.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Arrival: 4 retrieval questions including one Diwali comparison. Starter: menorah image — what might the candles communicate? I Do: tell the Hanukkah story in accessible chunks and introduce the menorah. We Do: sequence story/symbol cards and connect light to remembrance, faith and hope. You Do: complete a short ‘What happens? What does it mean?’ task. Exit ticket: one meaning of light at Hanukkah.

Look for

F: “What happens? What does it mean?” response.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

Chabad What is Hanukkah https://www.chabad.org/holidays/chanukah/article_cdo/aid/102911/jewish/What-Is-Hanukkah.htm

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.